Generative artificial intelligence - guidelines

Department of Education and Training

NORTHERN TERRITORY GOVERNMENT

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Read this document with the Generative artificial intelligence (AI) policy.

1. Guidelines summary

These guidelines provide detailed information for staff to ensure they can implement the requirements outlined in the Generative AI policy. The guidelines provide information on:

- defining and understanding generative AI
- using generative AI ethically, safely and responsibly
- teaching and learning about generative AI in schools.

2. Defining and understanding generative AI

Generative AI enables computers and systems to perform tasks that typically require human intelligence. We encounter AI in everyday products and services, such as search engines and smartphone assistants.

Generative AI is a branch of AI that can create new content, including text, images, videos, software code and music, mimicking human-like production.

Generative AI is trained by humans and computer programs using vast amounts of data to recognise patterns and determine the most suitable output in response to a given prompt. The output might be a sentence or paragraph describing the user's request. When prompted, it generates the desired output, such as a sentence, picture or model, aligned to the prompt.

Generative AI tools can benefit both staff and students. They have the potential to assist staff with administrative duties and support student learning.

However, these generative AI tools can also:

- display bias and perpetuate stereotypes present in the training data
- provide inaccurate information, such as leaving out crucial details or creating false information
- provide information that is not always original, instead providing the most likely response.

2.1. Common types of generative AI tools

There is a range of generative AI tools and functions available for schools and staff to consider for use. Some tools provide a single, standalone function while others combine multiple functions into one product or are embedded in other software. Below are some examples of generative AI tools available, noting examples provided are for reference only and not specifically recommended or endorsed by the department. Staff should view the Digital Application Catalogue for approved generative AI tools.

- Text generation – creates human like text, often known as large language models, for example, Microsoft 365 (M365) Copilot, ChatGPT, Gemini
- Image generation – creates images or transforms text into images, for example, M365 Copilot, DALL_E, Adobe Firefly
- Video generation – creates or edits video
- Audio generation – creates audio files, such as music, speech or sound effects
- Code generation – produces computer programming code

- Design generation – produces layouts, visuals and graphical elements.

2.2. Australian Framework

The Australian Framework for Generative Artificial Intelligence in Schools (the Framework) has been developed as a national approach to guide the responsible and ethical use of generative AI tools in ways that benefit students, schools and society. It offers guidance on understanding, using and responding to generative AI within the context of Australian school-based education.

The Framework is aspirational in nature, defining what safe, ethical and responsible use of generative AI should look like to support better school outcomes. Schools should use the Framework when making decisions about the implementation and use of generative AI.

3. Using generative AI ethically, safely and responsibly

Generative AI, while powerful and innovative, does have limitations such as bias, accuracy and reliability, and privacy concerns. It is imperative staff consider the advice below regarding safety and ethical considerations before using generative AI.

3.1. Privacy and security

When interacting with generative AI tools, it is essential to be aware of the potential privacy risks associated with the storage and analysis of conversations and personal data, to ensure compliance with the Information Privacy Principles as set out in the *Information Act 2002*. To minimise privacy and security risks, it is important to:

- ensure you do not enter any personal or identifiable information, including student work or details into generative AI tools, any personal information should be de-identified
- ensure you use approved generative AI tools to manage the risk that personal and sensitive information might be disclosed to external parties, used to train generative AI language models, or saved or stored for future use by the tool provider
- ensure you do not upload photos of students, staff or your school to generative AI tools
- ensure you do not upload any official government information, including draft documents, which are either protected, sensitive or confidential only use information that is classified as public.

3.2. Accountability

Content produced by generative AI tools is based on the data used for training the AI. This can lead the AI tool to reproduce inaccuracies or biases present in the training data. The AI tool may misrepresent information either unintentionally, as misinformation, or intentionally, as disinformation.

It is important to:

- critically analyse, evaluate and verify generative AI outputs by cross-referencing them with reliable sources and considering diverse perspectives
- understand you are responsible for any generative AI content that you create, share or use while performing your duties and for ensuring your use of generative AI is robust and safe.

3.3. Responsible use

Generative AI, like other digital technologies, can be misused in various ways. Staff have a responsibility to ensure their own use and student use of generative AI tools is appropriate.

Some examples of inappropriate use include:

- harassment: creating realistic but fake multimedia content to deceive or manipulate people, known as deepfakes
- privacy violation: using AI to access, share or exploit personal information without consent
- cultural appropriation: generating content that misrepresents or exploits cultural elements or traditions in a way that is disrespectful or offensive
- discrimination: producing biased outputs that reinforce stereotypes or unfair treatment of certain groups
- plagiarism: using AI to generate content that is copied or not properly attributed, undermining academic integrity
- copyright: inputting content into generative AI tools for which the user does not have copyright, including Indigenous cultures intellectual property.

3.4. Transparency

Transparency when using AI in schools is essential for building trust, ensuring fairness, promoting accountability, enhancing understanding and safeguarding privacy.

It is important that staff:

- ensure the school community and colleagues are appropriately informed when generative AI tools are used in ways that may impact them
- provide students with clear expectations about values, responsibilities and behaviours when using generative AI tools for learning and assessment.

Discuss the following when creating expectations for students:

- age restriction – most generative AI tools have age restrictions on their use and may require parent consent. It is important to check the platform's terms of service
- plagiarism – check that there are appropriate controls and strategies to identify misuse of AI tools and have open discussions with students about plagiarism. Turnitin is a department approved tool that can be used in conjunction with other evidence to help schools detect plagiarism
- acknowledgement – teach and support students to use age-appropriate ways to acknowledge or reference their use of generative AI for completing learning tasks
- clear guidelines about when they may or may not use AI.

3.5. Use of generative AI in schools and the workplace

Generative AI has the potential to support the delivery of education services by streamlining tasks, generating ideas, creating resources and supporting students. It does not replace the expertise and professional judgement of teachers and educational staff, nor should it undermine genuine communications with students and families.

Implementation and use of generative AI tools should be well planned in educational contexts with due regard given to safety, privacy, security, inclusivity, and responsible and ethical use.

It is a school-based and business unit decision to implement and use generative AI tools. School and system leaders must consider benefits versus value before using generative AI tools. They are also encouraged to monitor the implementation and use of AI tools and their impact on business objectives, learning and wellbeing outcomes.

Some examples of how teachers and staff can use generative AI are to:

- summarise, reword, analyse or compare information
- search for and contextualise information for a particular audience
- analyse de-identified information
- generate ideas for lesson planning or assessment tasks
- tailor learning tasks to support engagement of individual students
- reword information so students at different stages of learning can understand it
- act as a coach, stepping students through a defined procedure and providing feedback as they work
- create exemplars and visualisations to support learning.

3.5.1. Selecting generative AI tools

The department's Digital application catalogue provides a list of known and assessed digital applications, including generative AI tools that are approved for use. The catalogue is located on eLearn in the Digital resource hub and provides key information about each digital application, including the conditions of use, to support staff in mitigating against risks regarding security and privacy.

When selecting a generative AI tool, it is recommended that staff follow the below steps:

- Step 1: Identify what you are trying to achieve:
  - Have clear requirements of the need and associated benefits and outcomes.
  - Determine the costings and impact on your students and staff when introducing a new generative AI tool.
  - Review its alignment to the school and agency strategic directions.
- Step 2: Check the Digital applications catalogue:
  - Search for assessed and approved generative AI tools that meet your need.
  - Review their risk levels and conditions of use.
  - If there is an approved generative AI tool that meets your need, it is recommended that application is used.
  - If no approved generative AI tools are available that meet your need, go to step 3.
- Step 3: Submit a request for a new assessment
  - Submit a request for a new digital application using the Online and Cloud System Request form. Staff may be contacted during this process to source additional information to help inform the assessment process.

- An assessment will be conducted and information about the outcome will be communicated with the requestor. If approved, conditions of use will be generated and provided to the requestor and the application will be added to the catalogue.

More information on requesting an assessment of a digital application can be found on eLearn, staff log in required.

As technologies evolve, additional features and functionality may change how digital applications capture, use and store data. If you're using a generative AI tool that has these changes, it's important to submit a request to get it reassessed to ensure you're applying the right conditions to protect your and your students' data.

3.5.2. Implementation of generative AI tools

Staff should refer to the Generative AI Implementation Guide for support in identifying effective implementation activities.

The guide provides guidance on:

- establishing expectations with your staff on generative AI use
- effective prompting tips for use with generative AI tools
- professional development to support your understanding of generative AI and how it can be applied in your school or workplace
- measuring the impact of generative AI use to determine benefits and risks, including perception survey examples
- communication exemplars to support communication with staff, student and families.

The Digital application guidelines provide further information staff may find useful regarding ongoing management of digital applications in the workplace to support post implementation activities.

3.5.3. Copyright

The application of Australia's copyright law to AI platforms is yet to be addressed by the courts.

For current best-practice guidance on using generative AI platforms to generate new works and modify existing works for educational purposes, please refer to the Smartcopying Using Generative AI Platforms in Schools factsheet. If you require further details, please contact the National Copyright Unit at smartcopying@det.nsw.edu.au.

4. Teaching and learning about generative AI in schools

It is recommended schools help students understand and use generative AI tools where appropriate, by teaching them:

- what generative AI is, how it works, and its benefits and risks
- how to use generative AI tools safely and responsibly, avoiding potential harms
- how to effectively prompt generative AI tools
- how to evaluate and verify the outputs of generative AI
- appropriate conventions for attribution and acknowledgement of the use of generative AI outputs.

Educators should closely supervise students' use of digital technology, including generative AI tools. More information about teaching and learning about generative AI can be accessed in the Australian Curriculum: Artificial intelligence curriculum connection.

Some examples of how students can use generative AI are to:

- personalise learning
- test their knowledge or prepare practice questions for a specific task or topic
- assist with idea generation and writing
- explain information in alternative ways to help their understanding
- ask for specific feedback on work
- answer simple questions on a specific task or topic
- create a study plan or get advice on studying strategies.

4.1. Plagiarism and academic integrity

Schools should provide advice to students on appropriate and inappropriate use of generative AI tools in terms of assessment and completion of schoolwork. Schools, in particular secondary schools, may benefit from aligning these processes with those required for South Australian Certificate of Education (SACE) subjects.

When developing procedures to monitor plagiarism and upholding academic integrity, schools should focus on three key areas: prevention, detection and investigation of academic misconduct. The following sections outline practical guidance for addressing each of these components.

4.1.1. Prevention

Schools and teachers should:

- clearly identify in what situations generative AI is permitted or prohibited
- be clear about student expectations for documentation and attribution
- ensure students are aware of which uses of generative AI would be considered misconduct.

Students need to be taught about the benefits and limitations of generative AI tools to help them determine when use of generative AI may be helpful in their work. A clear curriculum for introducing, understanding and applying generative AI tools to students will prepare them to best understand how and when to use generative AI to enhance their learning.

Whenever generative AI has been used in the completion of an assessment, students must acknowledge the use of AI with appropriate referencing. This referencing should name the generative AI tools and provide a list of all prompts used to generate information. The SACE Board Guidelines for Referencing include suggestions for how schools and students might reference generative AI.

Students should be prepared to show ownership of their work by keeping drafts or a reflection journal during creation of the work. It should be expected that teachers may investigate possible plagiarism.

4.1.2. Detection

Digital tools for detecting the use of generative AI can be unreliable or inconclusive and should not be used in isolation to detect plagiarism violations. The Turnitin AI detection tool may be used to evaluate work in a claim of inappropriate use of generative AI, however, this score should be used in conjunction with other relevant evidence.

Schools can consider the SACE Supervision and Verification of Students' Work Policy and Procedures when deciding how they might authenticate student work. Some possibilities include:

- asking students to show evidence of the development of their work, for example, drafts or student notes
- completion of an alternative and equivalent task under more closely supervised conditions
- querying potential plagiarism.

4.1.3. Investigation

Schools should enact a process to ensure a consistent, fair and transparent response to claims of inappropriate use of generative AI tools in assessments. This school process should consider or align to the Breach of rules procedures of the SACE Board as appropriate for the school cohort.

The school investigation process should also document the inappropriate usage, clarify how inappropriate usage will be investigated and work with students and their parents to determine next steps.

4.2. Guidelines for using artificial intelligence in SACE assessments

The NT Certificate of Education and Training (NTCET) qualification is delivered in partnership with the SACE Board. Students studying the NTCET must follow the Guidelines for using Artificial intelligence in SACE assessments.

The following resources will help schools understand SACE requirements:

- The SACE Board Guidelines for Referencing.
- SACE Supervision and Verification of Students' Work Policy and Procedures.
- Breach of Rules - SACE board.

The SACE Board has determined that students can use generative AI in their school-based assessments in the same way as they would use any other research tool to source information.

To ensure that students are aware of and can comply with these guidelines, schools and teachers should consider how their processes for prevention, detection and investigation of breaches of academic integrity apply when students have used generative AI for an assessment. Students may need assistance to understand these processes.

5. Roles and responsibilities

Staff should refer to the Generative AI policy for an overview of roles and responsibilities.

6. Definitions

For full list of definitions see the Generative AI policy.

Term	Definition
academic integrity	Relates to assessment based on the work students have produced without undue assistance from other people or sources
Copyright	Refers to the protection of original works of authorship such as text, artistic works, music, computer programs, sound recordings and films
Bias	An inclination or prejudice for or against a person or group, especially in a way considered to be unfair
intellectual property	Relates to creations of the mind, such as inventions, literary and artistic works, designs, and symbols, names, and images
Plagiarism	Related to the copying, paraphrasing or summarising of work, in any form, without acknowledgment of sources, and presenting this as a student's own work
trained – referring to generative AI	Process of teaching an AI model to perform a task
Turnitin	An approved tool for schools to use to detect plagiarism

7. Related legislation, policy and resources

For a full list of related legislation, policy and resources see the Generative AI policy.

7.1. Policy

- Policy and the Information for parents and students printable - https://education.nt.gov.au/policies/conduct#headingNine-1397861
- Generative Artificial Intelligence staff toolkit, log in required - https://elearn.ntschools.net/policies/8284

7.2. Resources

- Smartcopying Using Generative AI Platforms in Schools factsheet - https://smartcopying.edu.au/using-generative-ai-platforms-in-schools/
- Australian Curriculum: Artificial intelligence curriculum connection - https://www.australiancurriculum.edu.au/curriculum-information/understand-this-curriculum-connection/artificial-intelligence#
- Guidelines for using Artificial Intelligence (AI) in SACE assessments - https://www.sace.sa.edu.au/teaching/assessment/assessment-and-academic-integrity/guidelines-for-using-ai
- The SACE Board Guidelines for Referencing - https://www.sace.sa.edu.au/documents/652891/722147/Guidelines+for+referencing.doc/038e8536-6804-461d-92c8-171d11080fee
- SACE Supervision and Verification of Students' Work Policy and Procedures - https://www.sace.sa.edu.au/documents/652891/91d6c2ae-1e6d-4d07-8c03-6abd619f1070

- Breach of Rules SACE board - https://www.sace.sa.edu.au/coordinating/admin/information-sheets/03
- Digital resource hub in eLearn - https://elearn.ntschools.net/supporting-staff/digital-resource-hub
- Turnitin AI detection tool - https://elearn.ntschools.net/supporting-staff/digital-applications/digital-applications-catalogue?title=turnitin&sort_bef_combine=weight_ASC#node4042

Acronyms	Full form
AI	Artificial Intelligence
Cth	Commonwealth
M365	Microsoft 365
NT	Northern Territory
NTCET	Northern Territory Certificate of Education
SACE	South Australian Certificate of Education

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